

1. The fact that there are contingent things is contingent.
2. Every contingent fact has an explanation. (PSR)
3. The fact that there are contingent things has an explanation. (1,2)
4. The fact that there are contingent things can't be explained by any contingent thing.
5. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some thing which is not contingent. (3,4)
6. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some necessary thing. (5)
7. There is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things. (6)
8. If there is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things, then God exists.

C. God exists. (7,8) (7,8)

We found reason to doubt
the idea that, if there is a
first cause, then God exists.
Do similar doubts apply to
premise (8) of Leibniz's
argument?

Here we can say things similar to the things we said about quasi-theism
when we were discussing the first cause hypothesis.

We can again consider the hypotheses of simple theism and simple atheism, and now consider alongside them the quasi-theistic hypothesis that the universe was created by a being with the unusual property that it is literally impossible for that being not to exist.

It is worth emphasizing one strength of Leibniz's argument as compared to the various versions of the first cause argument. That argument relies on the assumption that there are no infinite causal chains. The kalām argument also relies on the assumption that the universe began to exist at some time.

Leibniz's argument does not rely on either assumption. As he says:

I certainly grant that you can imagine that the world is eternal. However, since you assume only a succession of states, and since no reason for the world can be found in any of them ... it is obvious that the reason must be found elsewhere.

... even if we assume the eternity of the world, we cannot escape the ultimate and extramundane reason for things, God.

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THE COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT

We can again consider the hypotheses of simple theism and simple atheism, and now consider alongside them the quasi-theistic hypothesis that the universe was created by a being with the unusual property that it is literally impossible for that being not to exist.

If this strikes you as a
strange and unlikely
hypothesis, then premise 8
of Leibniz's argument
should strike you as a
plausible one.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR



contingent things is contingent.

2. Every contingent fact has an

1. The fact that there are

exp1a1aati0n.(PSR)

continuing to think has an

3. The facts that there are

exp1anation.(1,2)

6. The facts that there are

committing things can't be

4. The facts that there are

explained by any other thing.

5. The fact that there are

some necessary thing. (5)

contingent things is explained by

something which is not

C. Godel exists. (7,8) (7,8)

containing: (3,4)

exilis +

7. There is a necessary thing which

contingent things, then God



explains the existence of

8. If there is a necessary thing

continuing things. (6)

contingent things is explained by

which explains the existence of

first cause, then God exists.

argument?

We found reason to doubt

the idea that, if there is a

Do similar doubts apply to

premise(8) of Leibniz's

Here we can say things similar to the things we said about quasi-theism

when we were discussing the first cause hypothesis.

it is literally impossible for that being not to exist.

atheism, and notwithstanding the quasi-theistic hypothesis

that the universe was created by a being with the unusual property that

We can again consider the hypotheses of simple theism and simple

at some time.

argument also relies on the assumption that the universe began to exist

to the various versions of the first cause argument. That argument relies

on the assumption that there are no infinite causal chains. The kalām

It is worth emphasizing one strength of Leibniz's argument as compared



2. Every contingent fact has an

3. The fact that there are content

things is explained by some thing

things can't be explained by any

continuing things. (6)

things has an explanation. (1,2)

8. If there is a necessary thing which

which is not consistent. $(3, 4)$

6. The fact that there are countless

C. Good exists. (7, 8)

explains the experience of

containing nothing.

4. The fact that there are contingent

5. The fact that there are content

things is explained by some

1. The fact that there are continuing

exp1anation.(PSR)

things is coming in.

necessary thing. (5)

explains the existence of

7. There is a necessary thing which



contingent things, then God exists.



quasi-theistic hypothesis that

property that it is literally

being with the unusual

the universe was created by a

to exist.

considered along side them the

hypotheses of simple theism

and simple atheism, and now

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hypothesis, then premise 8

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



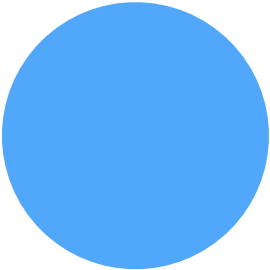
Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR

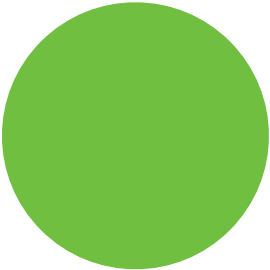


objections
to the
PSR









cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

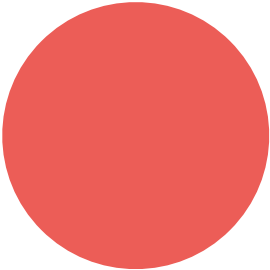
Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

be Good.







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